

Hybrid operations: desk playbook

CAS26 | Kristopher Turner | September 2026

Before you change anything

Name the **service**, **target**, **owner**, **evidence time** and **acting identity**. If one is unknown, investigate that gap before choosing a correction.

Five questions, one practice each

Section and question	Practice	Owner	Next action	Evidence
Observe: Is it working, and where do you look?	One place to look; alert on the order outcome, not the machine	Service owner + monitoring team	Build one service view and one outcome alert	A fresh order shows in it
Secure: Who is allowed to change it, and how is it protected?	The three key rules for people, machines and fix-up tools, plus Defender coverage	Security lead	List every identity that can change a server and check it against the rules	Review record and coverage report
Govern: Which team owns it, and does it stay the way we agreed?	Landing zone placement, Policy against a compliance standard, one patch process	Governance lead + platform team	Place Arc resources in the designed scope, assign a standard, tag every server with its patch ring	Compliance dashboard and ring results
Cost: What does it cost, and how do we keep it in check?	Tag everything, attest Software Assurance, set budgets	FinOps + service owner	Enforce tags with Policy, attest Software Assurance, create a budget per service	Cost by service and owner
Adopt: Did the fix work, and what do we keep doing?	Let the system fix things only with a proof step	Service owner	Pick one fix to hand to the system and define how it is verified	A fresh order after every change it makes

Who holds which key: three rules

- **People:** read-only by default; admin only when asked for, for a limited time, after MFA (PIM).
- **Machines and apps:** their own identity, only the permissions they need, no stored passwords.
- **Fix-up tools:** change one thing, in one place, and every change is logged.

Four independent doors, four keys: Azure (an Azure role), sign in (the server's own accounts), hosting (SCVMM or AWS admin), app + data (the app's own permissions). Run Command or extension rights are admin inside the server.

Pick the right place to ask

- **Resource Graph:** what exists: resource IDs, tags, placement and reported configuration or state.
- **Log Analytics / KQL:** what happened: events, Syslog, heartbeats, application records.
- **Metrics / PromQL:** how a number is trending; Prometheus-compatible metrics live in an Azure Monitor workspace.
- **A fresh order:** whether the service works now. Pair it with the stores above.

Agent + DCR = data; no DCR, no data. **Check the service, not just the servers.**

Letting the system fix things

Level	Who acts	Example
Report only	A person reviews; nothing changes on its own	Policy compliance report
Fix with approval	The system proposes; a person approves	Policy remediation task, an approved patch ring
Fixes continuously	The system corrects drift on its own	Flux on the EKS cluster

Every level ends in the same check: **verify the resource and the service**. Failed: stop the next step, restore where possible, escalate. Passed: close it and record the evidence. Before the system fixes anything, name the **owner**, **permissions**, **blast radius**, **when to stop**, and **how you prove it**.

What to unlearn

Section and assumption	Check instead
Observe: A heartbeat means it works	Run a fresh order
Secure: Connected means secured	Who holds which key, and Defender coverage
Govern: An assignment means compliance	Evaluation and remediation
Cost: No bill means free	The meter, the licence benefit and the allocation
Adopt: A finished task means recovery	Verify the outcome

Your first thirty days

- **Week 1:** inventory and owners (Govern).
- **Week 2:** access and the key rules (Secure); placement and Policy with a standard (Govern).
- **Week 3:** one service view and one alert on the outcome (Observe).
- **Week 4:** tags and budgets (Cost); one fix the system makes for you, proved by a fresh order (Adopt).

Start with one service and repeat the pattern.

Make every alert actionable

Service/customer impact: _____

Evidence and time window: _____

Owner and escalation contact: _____

Permitted action and scope: _____

Recovery evidence and stop condition: _____

See the **session companion** for diagrams, worked examples and references: query patterns in Appendix B, the service operating contract in Appendix C.